GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

March 25th, 2022
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Week 12

Highlights:

- **Challenging.**
- **India gains.**
- **Commodities firm.**
- **China Covid woe.**
- **Bangla mills.**

QUOTE of the WEEK

**"Talent wins games,
but teamwork and intelligence win championships."**

– *Michael Jordan*

MARKET COMMENTARY

VOLATILE!

It has been another challenging week in the sub-continent markets, with a resurgent India and a Bangladeshi market that is still reeling from some of the recent falls in local steel, which have seen nearly USD 50/LDT knocked off the prices this week alone.

India has managed to regain over half of the falls seen over the previous few weeks, but the market overall does remain extremely volatile.

Commodity prices and volatile currencies show few signs of cooling off any time soon, as the Russian invasion of Ukraine enters its second month and thus far shows no signs of abating. The Covid situation in China too may be a growing cause for concern as various cities (including the economic hub of Shanghai) enter a fresh series of lockdowns, while the rest of the world is just starting to open again.

The fact that there is very little natural immunity or a fully workable vaccine coverage (that hasn't already begun to wane) mean that China could be faced with another challenging period, both socially & economically and we can only hope that future virus mutations and inevitable closures do not become a part of everyday life once again.

While mills in Bangladesh had recently stopped buying steel at these higher overall levels approaching USD 700/LDT, they have however, slowly started to acquire small portions of inventory just to stay open and this will surely lead to greater confidence in purchasing larger amounts in due course, in iorder to bring Chattogram prices back up again.

Finally, the Turkish market sails through an uneventful week, with no changes or fresh arrivals reported.

For week 12 of 2022, GMS demo rankings / pricing for the week are as below.

Demo Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Weakening	660 / LDT	670 / LDT	680 / LDT
2	India	Improving	640 / LDT	650 / LDT	660 / LDT
3	Pakistan	Weakening	630 / LDT	640 / LDT	650 / LDT
4	Turkey	Steady	450 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT

BANGLADESH

Bounceback?

Sliding.

The Bangladeshi slide has inadvertently brought India back into the picture of late, and the two markets are now competing on tonnage, with India being a preference for those owners with geographically positioned units, such is the high price of fuel at the moment.

Steel prices have tumbled by nearly USD 50/LDT, leaving Bangladeshi demand softening and a genuine lack of local interest emerging at these new highs that were approaching USD 700/LDT (and excess).

Mills back buying.

Notwithstanding, despite steel mills not actively buying at these higher overall numbers, they are still helping keep the industry active by acquiring steel that was secured at lower levels. Though all of this may start to change if prices maintain / improve again and local Recyclers refuse to sell ship's steel for a loss.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

BACK IN BIZ!

India has come surging back into the picture this week and is now competitive with a Bangladeshi market that is currently enduring a brief lull due to softening steel plate prices there.

Competitive.

On the flip side, steel prices gained further ground in Alang (despite ending the week a marginal USD 4/Ton lower) whilst much of the volatile currency depreciation seems to be settling too, with the Indian Rupee firming from Rs. 76.5X, closer to Rs. 76.10 against the U.S. Dollar.

It will be interesting to see if India manages to secure any larger LDT market vessels, having primarily secured specialist, non-ferrous and HKC only unit this year, whilst much of the larger LDT Tankers and Bulkers have found their way to Pakistani or Bangladeshi shores.

Seeking vessels.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

HALF ASLEEP!

Not competitive

Pakistani Buyers appear invisible at the moment, as they are not even competitive with a resurgent India or worse, a weakening Bangladesh at the moment.

Even geographically positioned units have been ignoring a softer and far more reluctant Pakistani market and have sailed off on even longer voyages across to Bangladesh (especially at the start of this year, so diverse and volatile have pricing differentials between sub-continent locations been of late).

Nervous.

Yet, with the ongoing Russian incursion into Ukraine and the subsequent volatility in steel fundamentals, Gadani Recyclers remain nervous to offer at these higher prices and they are worried about just how far local fundamentals and subsequent sub-continent pricing on units eventually climb to.

This worry has lead to the Gadani market reporting no fresh arrivals at the waterfront this week, a first in quite a while for this market.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SETTLED.

After weeks of firming fundamentals, improving plate prices and a semi-weakening dollar, the Turkish market finally spent a week in relative modesty, with no major changes reported in domestic steel fundamentals (import or local plate prices) or even the currency, that has expectedly weakened with the ongoing crisis in the Baltic, declining past the TRY 14.80 mark against the U.S. Dollar this week.

Quiet week.

There is not much to report from Aliaga with minimal local activity being reported, logical, given the lack of available market tonnage. There were also no fresh arrivals even reported this week.

Stay firm?

Overall, a silent, yet firm period in Turkey prevails and with the Ukraine invasion in full swing, it is even expected to stay this way in the coming weeks.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

AMAZING FACTS

- *Animals that lay eggs don't have belly buttons.*
- *Mr. Potato Head was the first toy to be advertised on TV.*
- *Boanthropy is the psychological disorder in which patients believe they are a cow.*
- *Camels have three eyelids.*
- *There is a McDonalds in every continent except Antarctica.*
- *Mosquitos are attracted to people who just ate bananas.*
- *In South Korea, there is an emergency number to report suspected spies (it's 113!).*
- *Cats have over 100 vocal cords.*
- *Sonic the Hedgehog's full name is Ogilvie Maurice Hedgehog.*
- *The world's termites outweigh the world's humans about 10 to 1.*
- *Most toilet paper sold in France is pink.*
- *The Hawaiian alphabet only has 12 letters.*
- *The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.*
- *Children tend to grow faster in the spring.*
- *The television was invented two years after the invention of sliced bread.*
- *If you keep a goldfish in a dark room, it will eventually turn white.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**BEACHING TIDES**
April 10 – Ram Navami April 15 – Good Friday	March 30 – April 05 April 16 – April 22

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**BEACHING TIDES**
April 14 – Bengali New Year's Day April 29 – May Day	April 01 – April 04 April 17 – April 20

IMPORTANT BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
April 05 – Qinming Festival	**No holidays in April**	April 23 – National Sovereignty and Children's Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of March 25, 2022

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*AD 90 (Under Tow)*	*5,719*	*Jack-up*	*Beached March 25*
2	Berge Arctic	27,461	Bulk Carrier	Arrived March 25
3	*Bras XV (Under Tow)*	*13,363*	*Supply Vessel*	*Beached March 22*
4	*Cape Enterprise*	*22,043*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Beached March 18*
5	*Helsingfors*	*3,930*	*Fishing Vessel*	*Beached March 19*
6	Kigoriak	4,855	Ice Breaker	Arrived March 20
7	MNG Capt James Cook (Under Tow)	2,778	Supply Vessel	Arrived February 12
8	*Moskovskaya Olimpiad*	*3,916*	*Fishing Vessel*	*Beached March 23*
9	*Nand Aparna (Under Tow)*	*796*	*Barge*	*Beached March 18*
10	*Roqu (Under Tow)*	*12,194*	*Pipe Layer*	*Beached March 24*
11	*Supporter (Under Tow)*	*3,853*	*Barge*	*Beached March 25*
12	*Tag 4 (Under Tow)*	*1,803*	*Supply Vessel*	*Beached March 25*
Total Tonnage		**102,711**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of March 25, 2022

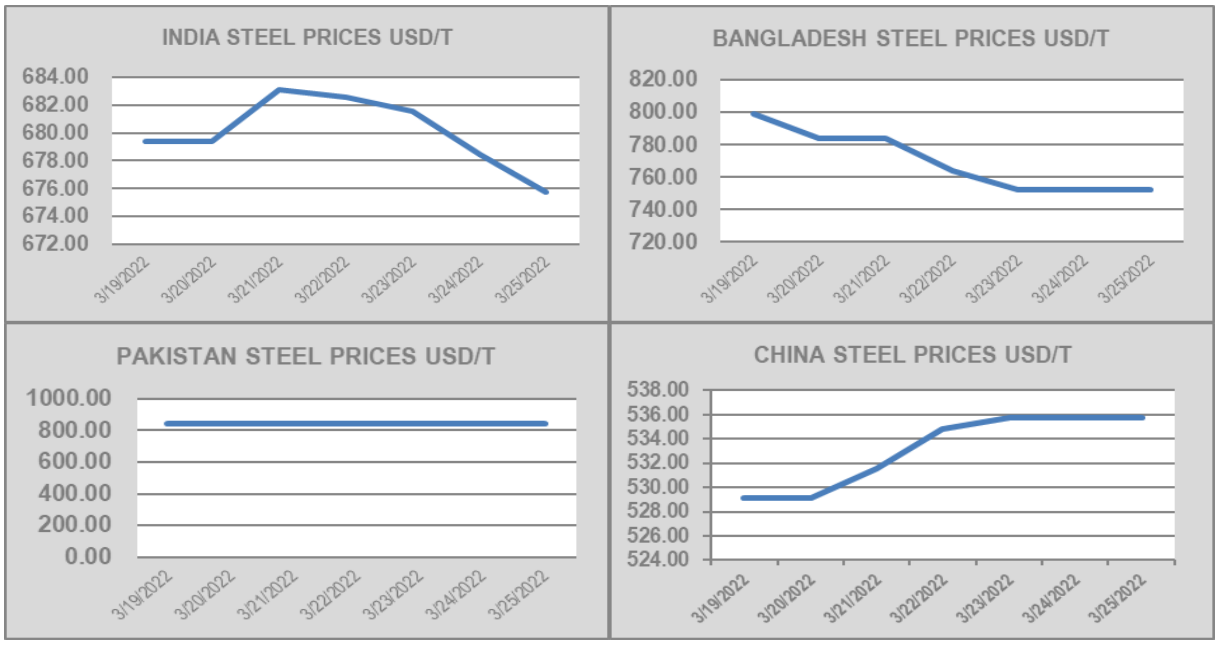
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Aristos*	*10,529*	*Tanker*	*Beached March 19*
2	*Asian Glory*	*3,413*	*Tanker*	*Beached March 23*
3	Basundhara	7,782	Bulk Carrier	Arrived March 20
4	*EX BNS Shahjalal*	*TBA*	*Supply Vessel*	*Beached March 22*
5	Gala	16,885	Tanker	Arrived February 28
6	*Kapten Caroq*	*20,015*	*Tanker*	*Beached March 21*
7	*Latitude*	*43,705*	*Tanker*	*Beached March 23*
8	*Ocean Mariner*	*3,290*	*Reefer*	*Beached March 23*
9	*One Vision*	*13,616*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Beached March 19*
10	*Petrogaruda*	*19,015*	*Tanker*	*Beached March 20*
11	*Rugen 7*	*8,865*	*Tanker*	*Beached March 20*
Total Tonnage		**147,115**		

GADANI - Port Position as of March 25, 2022

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
	No new arrivals reported this week.			
Total Tonnage		**-**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
3/19/2022	679.42	51,500.00	845.71	148,000.00	799.06	68,000.00	529.13
3/20/2022	679.42	51,500.00	845.71	148,000.00	783.78	66,700.00	529.13
3/21/2022	683.13	52,000.00	845.71	148,000.00	783.78	66,700.00	531.59
3/22/2022	682.59	52,000.00	845.71	148,000.00	763.81	65,000.00	534.84
3/23/2022	681.52	52,000.00	845.71	148,000.00	752.06	64,000.00	535.73
3/24/2022	678.45	51,800.00	845.71	148,000.00	752.06	64,000.00	535.73
3/25/2022	675.75	51,600.00	845.71	148,000.00	752.06	64,000.00	535.73



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